

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

they can be done more quickly or with less effort in order to solidify the habit, before gradually scaling up. A good example of this could be setting up a standing order to your savings account for a very small amount of money in order to create the habit, and then increasing the amount as you make other positive changes and have more money to save.

Lastly, we need to make our new money habits **satisfying**. This one can feel tricky for a few different reasons, the first being that, with money, often the satisfying feeling really doesn't occur naturally until a little further down the line, when you begin to see the fruits of your efforts – whether that's seeing the cash stack up in your savings or a significant reduction in debt. This is where we need to find manual rewards for executing our new habits – but rewarding ourselves is often associated with spending money, which might be one of the habits we're trying to break, so we have to find other ways to light up that reward centre in our brains. Before I'd even heard of James Clear and his methods, I used a 100-square grid to track my progress out of debt, colouring in a square every time I paid off 1% of the total that I owed, and I found it incredibly motivating and rewarding. Perhaps you could do something similar, or look at other ways of tracking your progress that also feel rewarding? You can also consider using small material rewards, such a new lipstick or book, for milestones along the way to financial wellbeing, remembering to celebrate those non-tangible wins, such as enforcing boundaries, as well as monetary ones.